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FINAL EXAMINATION

Section 1: - Short Answer Questions

1.1- Realism: According to Waltz, what are the two criteria that define the international political structure? How do realists view the possibility of fundamental change in the international system? Explain the different perspectives on the balance of power (unipolarity, bipolarity, multipolarity).

Two primary criteria are used by Kenneth Waltz's structural realism, sometimes known as neorealism, to explain the international political system. The first one being the Ordering Principle. Anarchy, or the absence of a centralized power governing states, is a feature of the global system. In a self-help structure, nations are independent bodies that are each in control of ensuring their own survival. The global framework does not have a centralized governing body, as compared with traditionally hierarchical local political structures. The second criteria are the Distribution of capabilities. Countries vary in their capacity to exercise authority, including their scientific, military, and economic prowess. The country's standing within the international framework is determined by those attributes. Every nation within anarchic systems carries out identical fundamental tasks, with the sole variation being their relative strength, in contrast to Functional differentiation within internal affairs. (Waltz, 1979; Donnelly, 2005; Elman 2005). Waltz focuses upon the way the global system's framework affects patterns of interactions and limits the activity of states. Waltz and other realists doubt that the international order will undergo significant change. Researchers contend multiple arguments. First, they contend that it is doubtful that the system's

anarchic architecture will alter, given it has endured across centuries. In anarchy, countries still place a higher priority upon power as well as survival. Secondly, classical realists contend that systemic alteration is unlikely since a nation's action is motivated by greed among individuals as well as the desire for dominance. In all, because it places more emphasis on perennial trends including violence as well as power relationships compared to groundbreaking shifts in world politics realism is a theory more suited to analyzing consistency compared to radical change (Waltz, 1979; Donnelly, 2005; Elman 2005). There are different perspectives on the balance of power. The first one being Unipolarity. Realists frequently contend that unipolarity seems problematic given that it encourages different nations to engage within balancing activities. Alliances may be formed by emerging nations to offset the dominant nation 's supremacy. The second one is the bipolar system. According to waltz, a bipolar system tends to be of utmost stability and durability. Because great power's main goal is to compete with the other great power, there is less chance of committing an error. Since partnerships are based on two significant powers, bipolarity is durable. Lastly, we have Multipolarity. Multipolarity is viewed as not as solid when influence is distributed across several nations. Owing to the difficulty of regulating conduct as well as changing coalitions, there raises the prospect of errors in judgment as well as confrontation. The realists argue over the extent to which multipolarity increases options towards adaptable diplomacy or increases vulnerability. Overall, the fundamental focus of realism on the persistent character of anarchy as well as power struggles in influencing how states interact with one another can be observed throughout this viewpoint regarding global framework, modifications, as well as polarity (Waltz, 1979; Donnelly, 2005; Elman 2005).

1.2: - Liberal Internationalism: What are the core tenets of Liberal Internationalism post-Cold War, as outlined by Burchill? How does this approach differ from realism in its view of international cooperation? (1 point)

Following the Cold War, liberal internationalism had a resurgence in popularity as it attempted to lay out and advance worldwide collaboration by means of open markets, democratic rule, rights for individuals, and frameworks of institutions. Scott Burchill claims that the following are the fundamental tenets of liberal institutionalism. First fundamental tenant is Democracy as well as Peace (Burchill, 2005). Considering liberal democracies embrace ideals like freedom for individuals, democratic governance, including the rule of law, they are essentially friendly in their dealings with other countries which hold the same democratic values. Doyle's separate peace theory holds that liberal nations acknowledge one another's legitimacy in return, which lessens the motivation to go to war with one another. In other words, Democratic nations do not go to war with one another. The second fundamental tenant is Open, free market economies. By establishing reciprocal economic reliance, trading freely fosters collaboration and eliminates friction. Subsequently moves the emphasis from capturing territory to extracting revenue via commerce and investment. The third fundamental tenant being institutions and worldwide collaboration. Liberal institutionalists contend that by establishing standards and regulations that prevent chaos, organizations such as the World Trade Organization (WTO), the European Union, as well as the United Nations promote collaboration (Burchill, 2005). These encourage nations to make decisions in manners which satisfy both parties by boosting consistency as well as trustworthiness. The fourth fundamental tenant is the rights of individuals and the promotion of justice. A fundamental component of liberal internationalism is the defense and advancement of the rights of humanity. regardless of whether they go against conventional ideas of the sovereignty of states, this encompasses encouragement of world legal structures such as the International Criminal Court

(ICC) including the 1948 Universal Declaration of Human Rights. The final fundamental tenant is the hope for prospective advancements. The foundation of liberal internationalism is faith in the growth of humanity including the possibility of a global framework founded on common principles, democratic leadership, and mutually beneficial economic relationships (Burchill, 2005). Liberal Institutionalism and Realism diverge on multiple fronts. In terms of Anarchy, realism claims that rivalries over power as well as anarchy govern global interactions, with actions determined by the need to survive. On the other hand, liberal internationalism contends that organizations, common standards, and collaboration might reduce anarchy. Secondly, we have prospective collaborations. Realists place a strong emphasis on achieving comparative advantages, holding those nations' main goal is to outperform their competitors. Yet liberal internationalism emphasizes absolute gains, whereby cooperation is encouraged by reciprocal advantages. Third front is human Nature. Realists believe that world politics will always involve war so they are pessimistic about advances in humanity (Burchill, 2005; Donnelly, 2005; Elman, 2005). Liberals contend that dialogue along with logic may bring about lasting tranquility because they have faith that humanity's character is ideal. Last front of divergence is the Institutions. Realists contend that institutions serve the greater good of dominant countries and rank them as subsidiary to power relations. On the other hand, liberals believe that institutions are essential for influencing actions, encouraging collaboration, therefore lessening the consequences of anarchy. By highlighting the transformational potential of democracy, commerce, and organizations in promoting an improved harmonious and collaborative global system, liberal internationalism departs significantly from realism (Burchill, 2005; Donnelly, 2005; Elman, 2005).

1.3: - Critical Theory: What role does the "politics of knowledge" play in shaping IR according to Linklater? How does critical theory challenge the idea of value-free inquiry in international relations? (1 point)

According to Andrew Linklater, critical theory's "politics of knowledge" demonstrates that interests as well as power influence the emergence and distribution of knowledge throughout the context of global relations. Critical theorists contend that societal, political, along with historical factors affect knowledge in IR in order to advance specific objectives rather than being impartial / value-free. Conventional ideologies that frequently portray themselves as being unbiased and truthful, such as Neo-Realism as well as neoliberalism, are attacked by critical thought. Theorists of critical thought contend through disguising their political consequences, these strategies uphold the status quo of power. The idea that theories are made for a certain aim for a specific individual had been rendered popular by Robert Cox (Linklater, 2005a; Devetak, 2005a). This demonstrates how the generation of data is fundamentally political in nature, supporting prevailing viewpoints while excluding others. The idea of value-free research in the international relations field of inquiry is expressly rejected by critical theory, which emphasizes subsequent arguments which challenge it. Emancipatory objectives are the primary objective of critical theory, which seeks to recognize and eliminate oppressive and unequal systems. The way that capitalist ideologies conceal oppression beneath the pretense of inherent and unchangeable structures provides a single instance for how critical thinkers influenced by Marxist theory approach. Furthermore, conventional international relations theories like neorealism are dominated by positivism, which is criticized for its emphasis upon "law-like patterns" as well as its alleged objectivity. (Linklater, 2005; Devetak, 2005). Positivism, according to critical thinkers, encourages the productive management of community as opposed to tackling the core issues of equality as well as emancipation. Moreover, immanent critique—which evaluates cultures according to their particular standards of

legitimacy—is used in the field of critical theory. In this regard, it highlights inconsistencies within the declared ideals underlying freedom and equal opportunity throughout capitalist countries as well as the actualities of oppression and unequal treatment (Linklater, 2005a; Devetak, 2005a). Furthermore, Jürgen Habermas created the concept of "knowledge-constitutive interests," which separates human goals that drive research into three categories: technical (environmental administration), practical (comprehending interpersonal relations), as well as emancipatory (the liberty against oppression). Traditional theories overlook the emancipatory interest, which is the focus of critical theory. Theories are "always for someone and for some purpose," as Cox famously put it, and they constantly serve specific purposes while working contrary to others as well (Devetak, 2005a, p. 141). Determining the political ramifications for assertions and investigating the globe within an impartial manner is, thus, a primary objective of critical theory. In conclusion, the subjective nature as well as political prejudices that are constructed into international relations theories are highlighted by the politics of knowledge within critical theory. It highlights the significance of discussing injustice, power, especially emancipation in global politics by denying value-free research (Linklater, 2005a; Devetak, 2005a).

1.4: - Constructivism: According to Reus-Smit, how does anarchy differ based on social interactions and shared norms? Provide a quote from the assigned readings to support your answer. What are the implications of this view of anarchy for international relations? (1 point)

Within the section entitled Constructivism, Christian Reus-Smit argues that the essence of anarchy within international relations is created through interpersonal relationships, common standards,

including sovereign shared identities rather than being rigid or homogeneous. The rationalist belief that anarchy inevitably results in self-help initiatives as well as struggles in power which has been criticized by constructivists. Rationalists assume that anarchy inevitably results in self-help initiatives as well as struggles in power which have been criticized by constructivists. Rather, scholars contend that the connections as well as common values of global players socially generate implications along with consequences of anarchy (Rues-Smit, 2005). There are important distinctions within anarchy rooted in social norms. According to Reus-Smit, how nations interpret anarchy varies according to their beliefs, identities and particularly the standards they adhere to. For instance, while anarchy may encourage collaboration within an arrangement of mutually beneficial nations, it could also encourage rivalry under a structure of antagonistic ones. Furthermore, constructivism emphasizes the reciprocal interaction between actors, or states, along with structures, or anarchy, in which established standards along with common values both impact as well as are shaped through state conduct. "Identities are the basis of interests" (Reus-Smit, 2005, p. 197-198). The implications of this view of anarchy for international relations are multiple. Anarchy's impacts vary depending on the dominant beliefs, customs, and relationships throughout the global structure. In contrast to acting out of innate survival instincts, states may decide to engage productively or aggressively depending on common views. In addition, countries' identity including the framework of international relations are formed by common values, which also have an impact on results including collaboration, disputes, including establishment of institutions. Finally, it underscores shifts within global structures. Constructivism offers a structure for comprehending the way changes in concepts and standards; such as preserving the environment as well as rights for humanity; gradually altering the character of societies of states. In conclusion, Reus-Smit's constructivist method emphasizes the manner in which anarchy represents a construct of society formed through relations between states as well as common values rather than an

established framework. This viewpoint offers an innovative as well as normative perspective on international relations, challenging conventional realism along with rationalist views (Rues-Smit, 2005).

Section 2: - Analytical Essays

2.2: - The State and Sovereignty: Drawing on the work of Ashley, explains how the concept of sovereignty is constructed, and how this relates to the idea of anarchy. How do states attempt to "expunge any traces of anarchy that reside within them"? Discuss challenges to sovereignty by non-Western states and implications for international relations.

Ashley is a prominent postmodernist scholar, which tried to challenge the conventional way of looking at what sovereignty and anarchy is. Ashley maintains that conventional approaches' definitions of terms such as sovereignty and anarchy are determined by might, influence, and the language employed to produce such knowledge. Sovereignty and anarchy are not unbiased, as traditional views argue, nor are they fundamentally naturally occurring. This argument is influenced by Micheal Foucault Power-Knowledge nexus. His power-Knowledge nexus asserts that power and knowledge are inextricably linked. Power generates certain knowledge, and knowledge, in turn, generates specific paradigms of dominance. One cannot be without the other. This demonstrates the core assumption of postmodernism: there are no universal truths, and knowledge is heavily influenced by systems of power that dictate how knowledge is disseminated (Devetak, 2005b). Circling back to Ashley, who was highly influenced by Micheal Fauclo's power-knowledge nexus, extended this argument to expose how the idea of Sovereignty is a manufactured perception produced as a narrated concept to practice might and domination. Knowledge structures that constitute and justify the authority of governments yet discriminating against different types of influence are what preserve sovereignty. As an instance, the formation

of contemporary countries coincided with the creation of judicial structures, stories about history, and government agencies that established the state as the most prevalent source of dominance (Devetak, 2005b). In addition, the use of language as well as symbolism serves to safeguard sovereignty. Utilizing regulations, historical narratives, as well as symbolism (which include banners as well as nationalistic songs), the nation-state suppresses underlying fractured and disputed origins as well as projects state formation as something that is homogeneous and inherent component (Devetak 2005b; Edkins, 2005). Furthermore, the dual phrases anarchy and sovereignty, which are considered interrelated, have been constructed. Ashley challenges the usual description of sovereignty and anarchy by reading the anarchy problematique twice. Ashley was influenced by Derrida's double reading approach, which is a method used by dismantling the text used to comprehend how speech or cultural structures are constructed or placed there. According to traditional ideas, sovereignty signifies domestic stability and a regulatory ideal, whereas anarchy symbolizes the unpredictable global framework beyond the nation's boundaries as well as the denial of sovereignty. Ashley also attempts to reveal the ways in which anarchy and sovereignty are perceived as simultaneously detrimental and mutually exhaustive. The Sovereign state attempts to regulate order domestically due to the chaotic external theme outside its borders within the international system. This demonstrates that anarchy is a created form intended to legitimize governmental might and authority accumulation. The double reading of the Anarchy problematique allowed Ashley to first display how anarchy and sovereignty are dual molded concepts. Second, it enabled Ashley to undermine the fundamental principles of anarchy and sovereignty as held by conventional views. Ashley's objective was to show readers how the terms anarchy and sovereignty mirror interactions of power and discursive procedures instead of representing absolute reality (Devetak 2005b; Edkins, 2005). Nations strive to "expunge any traces of anarchy that reside within them" with the objective of quelling internal instabilities and

maintaining the false appearance of total legitimacy, as sovereignty is a manufactured phenomenon rather than a natural one (Devetak, 2005b, p.172). Ashley, heavily influenced by Foucault's Power-Knowledge nexus, strives to describe five distinct ways that states struggle to eliminate the remnants of anarchy. The first option is to transfer the entire authority to the Centre. This approach could ensure devastating consequences on decentralized forces such as communal authorities, while also promoting government structures and reinforcing one integrated power. This decision may have unintended consequences for the state; rather than keeping order, it may spark an internal insurrection (Devetak 2005b). The second way states “expunge any traces of anarchy that reside within them” (Devetak 2005b, p. 171) is the full control on the usage of aggression. Referring to Marx Weber's argument, the state is the only entity that has the legal right to employ force when it is deemed necessary. Increasing military equipment procurement, intensifying military training, and performing surveillance are all measures taken to mitigate danger. The third technique of the state to form an illusion that the state's domestic order is not disorganized is the construction of legislation, rules and regulations. The main objective is to clarify the government's power and dominance. These regulations aim to provide a false appearance of control whereas eliminating dispute. The fourth approach is to develop a patriotic consciousness. The goal is to foster a sense of community inside a strictly modified boundary. The government begins by creating banners, national anthems, and monuments to help unite the citizens as a whole. This method disables and isolates minorities to prevent them from questioning an opposing identity and disrupting the so-called order. An example of that is the Chinese Uyghur population. In the northwest province of Xinjiang, Beijing is reportedly charged of performing crimes against humanity potentially perpetrating extermination targeting the Uyghur population along with different predominantly Muslim minority populations (BBC News, 2022). The capacity to communicate in their own tongue, practice their faith, and demonstrate other crucial facets of their culture is prohibited for

Uyghurs. Clothes, language acquisition, dietary habits, and schooling are among the many components of existence that are subject to control. The Chinese authorities continually track Uyghur religious establishments. Apparently simple behaviors like worshipping or visiting the imam can constitute grounds for arrest or detention (BBC News, 2022). The final tool that regimes use to create a false perception of actuality is espionage and the Foucault notion of biopolitics. The state seeks to give society an aura of stability and security by controlling and monitoring all elements of human existence, from education to healthcare. All these strategies interact to diminish and put pressure on domestic disparities, while also strengthening the government's right to complete power and concealing the fact that sovereignty is a weak and created concept rather than one that develops naturally (Devetak, 2005b; Edkins, 2005). It's imperative to discuss the challenges to sovereignty in non-western nations, which is reflected Ashley's post-modernist analysis. These countries' sovereignty is not intact and is extremely weak because underlying disparities and the rule of colonizers. Colonialism influence is the primary reason why non-western countries struggle to strengthen their sovereignty. The colonial powers' demarcation of these nations' borders resulted in a series of unending disasters throughout the area. Fragile national identities developed through the formation of these frontiers lead to disparities in ethnicity. Post-colonial governance also imposed sovereignty over these nations from outside, as in Chad and Sudan, posing a challenge to legitimacy within such countries. Furthermore, the military intervention of external western powers over Iraq or NATO in Libya frequently endangered the sovereignty of those struggling countries. Not to mention how the World Bank and the International Monetary Fund's structural economic adjustments to the formerly colonized entities had unintended consequences and made those countries more reliant on these bodies, thereby preventing them from ever achieving economic independence or even authority over their own economies. This capitalist system, sponsored by such institutions and western governments,

deepens inequities and exploitation of resources there (Devetak, 2005b; Edkins, 2005). Such postmodern assessment has significant implications for the discipline of international relations. It challenged the major tenants of certain conventional theories in the discipline such as realism and structural realism. For example, it undermined their view of anarchy and self-help as inherent instances, in addition Ashley maintained that it is a dialectical fabrication to subjugate the masses and strengthen authority. Ashley also urged for a reconsideration of the definition of sovereignty. He contended that sovereignty is a historically created ideal whose shape changes based upon the historical setting in which it is situated. Power is usually portrayed as material, the more military might and economic capabilities a state acquires the more powerful it is. However, postmodernists claim that power is shaped by the usage of language, representation, and knowledge. Powerful states can control an entire nation by the usage of media outlets and can even control how states and other populations perceive it by the use of discursive elements which then entails more power. Furthermore, postmodernism uncovers the Western conception of sovereignty as conditioned by history and not appropriate worldwide, particularly to formerly colonized states. Sovereignty frequently functions via being excluded, as evidenced via immigrants, captives, and those who have been stripped full legitimate political status. This can be evidenced under Agamben's theory on Guantanamo Bay. He contended that due to state sovereignty, some procedures were not followed in the Guantanamo Bay detention facility, subjecting the prisoners to brutal treatment and instances of assault, which he refers to as the state of exception. In conclusion, Sovereignty is a weakly constructed concept (Devetak, 2005b; Edkins, 2005). There are certain strengths and weaknesses regarding these observations made. A weakness in my opinion lies within the idea of the postmodernist claim of rejecting any universal truth. However, the assertion that there isn't a universal truth is a knowledge claim. Although Postmodernists deny fundamental truths and believe knowledge is always linked to power, they nonetheless produce information about how the

world operates. This could be interpreted as a flaw in postmodernist arguments (Edkins, 2005). Another drawback is their inability to provide solutions to global issues. In my view their arguments are significant in challenging mainstream ideals in international relations theory, separating sovereign power from biopolitics, and emphasizing the difference between the two (Edkins, 2005). Their strength lies within their genealogy and the deconstruction process used which is an instrument that is quite valuable. The Genealogical and deconstruction approaches strive to discover universal truths and their underlying meanings. Instead of analyzing historical evolution, the genealogical approach challenges the regimes of truth, or the unquestionable truths that have always existed. This reinforces the post-modernist position by illuminating marginalized and oppressed knowledge that those structures up there have been suppressing (Edkins, 2005).

2.6: - The English School and Global Order: How does the English School view the relationship between order and justice in international affairs? Discuss the "revolt against the West" and its implications for contemporary IR, **including an assessment of whether the English School's methodology is suited to addressing these issues.

The English school is a school of thought that falls within the center of the realist assumption and the liberal assumption on how relationships between nations function in practice. The English School's core argument asserts that international relations do not necessarily exist through a structure characterized by anarchy and the struggle for power, according to what the realists declare, and certainly not as an initiative in the direction of a long-lasting collaboration, according to the liberals. However, the key component of the English school proclaims that international relations establish an international society (a structure) in which self-governing countries function inside of what could be seen as a state of anarchy (realist assertion) yet obey common values, rules,

including institutions (liberal assertion) (Linklater, 2005b; Bellamy, 2005). In other words, the English school of thought combines and creates sort of an equilibrium among core principles presented by Realist school of thought stating the importance security and the survival as well as Liberal school of thought, can be portrayed as an Idealistic view, stating the potential for future advancements and collaborations (Linklater, 2005b; Bellamy, 2005). Overall, while English School Scholars acknowledge the constant aggression faced in the world and the lack of an overarching authority to check and balance over states misconduct, order continues to be established by international society when countries adopt shared rules and values, as opposed to the international system, in which countries function exclusively pursuant to relationships of power, with no regard for shared values or norms (Linklater, 2005b; Bellamy, 2005). According to the English School of Thought, the study of Order and Justice in International Relations is critical. However, in order to help shed some illumination on the association between Order as well as Justice in international relations, it is necessary to identify several types of international society. The solidarist and pluralist theories of international society were rendered distinct by Hedley Bull. He ultimately pointed out that the basic solidarist premise, particularly originated in the Grotian tradition, regards nations as possessing commonality of duty as well as prospective unity, in particular when maintaining the rule of law internationally. Second, ethical variations like recognizing fair versus unfair conflicts are particularly highlighted via the solidarist perspective. Thirdly, the solidarist perspective provides validity to humanitarian intervention along with various measures, arguing that people, in addition to governments, constitute an element of society of states (also known as International Society). In all, the Solidarist perspective promotes greater universal norms and values along with fundamental structures emphasizing the reach for justice, and this includes humanitarian intervention (Linklater, 2005b; Bellamy, 2005). On the other hand, the Pluralist perspective, which bases itself upon Vattel's methods, perceives nations to be

inherently sovereign in addition focuses exclusively with the simplest attainable objectives such as cooperation alongside autonomy. Second, it opposes more extensive solidarist principles, arguing that sovereign nations, rather than humans, represent the primary constituents of society of states. In other words, the viewpoint of pluralism emphasizes the fundamental idea of sovereignty alongside a restricted collaboration between nations (Linklater, 2005b; Bellamy, 2005). Bulls' view of the extent to which a Pluralist versus Solidarist international society is evolving is ambiguous, but his analysis concerning the way international society moderate in between sovereignty as well as collaboration following the Second World War continues to be fundamentally pluralistic. Protecting every country's autonomy, that has frequently conflicted alongside the objectives of upholding the equilibrium of power as well ensuring tranquility, is the key obstacle surrounding international relations, whereas the tension regarding pluralist and solidarist stances reflects this. In other words, there is enormous tension over the concepts of order and justice, and the struggle derives from the central issue of how to reconcile both concepts (Linklater, 2005b; Bellamy, 2005). The English school views the relationship between Justice and Order as an intriguing interplay. Order is a circumstance where all sovereign nations exist alongside each other in a peaceful manner, taking into consideration the idea of not intrenching into one another's territorial integrity to preserve harmony amongst the societies of states. It puts security, tranquility, and international law up in a pedestal underscoring the role of diplomatic maneuvers as essential to preserve all of these elements combined. An example of Order is the balance of power. On the other hand, Justice is all about promoting just and moral ideals among the societies of states for instance the protection of the rights of people all around the world, the economic equality, and the ethical duties which goes beyond the sovereignty of a nation. The reason why it is Intriguing and why there is a tension between them, according to English school scholars, like bull, is that the efforts to preserve order in the world is a tradeoff to achieving justice

(Linklater, 2005b; Bellamy, 2005). Trying to achieve this balance between the two is highly complicated. An illustration of this would be the different instances during the first half of the nineteenth century that Polish statehood was relinquished for the aim of global stability. Another example is when the League of Nations refused protect Ethiopia, against Italian incursion given that France and England wanted Italy as an ally to equalize Nazi Germany's dominance. In these conditions, order gained precedence above justice, which mandates that every single nation receives consideration fairly. In addition, the current society of states presents extra instances which underscores the complex interplay between order and justice. Order necessitates attempts against new recruits to the nuclear club, but justice implies that every single country holds the right to acquire WMDs (Linklater, 2005b; Bellamy, 2005).

Another contemporary example that reflects this complex interplay between justice and order is the Hamas-Israeli conflict. When Hamas attacked Israel on the 7th of October last year, Israel perceived that attack as highly offensive to its states sovereignty and pulled out the defensive card of the right to defend itself and ensure the national security of its state. To maintain order, the international actor took a stance of non-interference in the conflict, for the sake of not destabilizing the regional order and respecting Israel's territorial Integrity. While the Justice point of view, portrays Israel's action and the silence of the international community to be frowned upon, underscoring the need to stop casualties and calls for the immense need of a humanitarian intervention and to provide the Palestinians the right to statehood. However, an intervention to achieve justice would destabilize Order. Justice is interpreted differently by various entities. While some members of the international community, including Israelis, believe that Israel's acts of genocide and the destruction of Hamas's infrastructure in Gaza are actually fair given that Israel is defending the rights of its citizens and the integrity of its borders, Palestinians may see Israeli occupation, crimes against humanity, and development in the West Bank as unfair. Development

in achieving justice and order within this world is deemed to be very weak. The English school fails to understand that states act out of pure interest and the decision to intervene or not is not based on the protection of human rights but rather if it would benefit the states strategic interest within the geopolitical reality. Order is even perceived as peaceful coexistence between states and the respect of each state's territorial integrity, however how is the waging of a war for the sake of balancing power is the sole reason to maintain stability? Killing of thousands of innocent people seems to hinder order as well as justice. But this circles back to the perception of one's idea of what justice is, and to which camp they belong to. This view was held by the scholar Jackson, be viewed as portraying a pluralist stance, arguing the human rights tend to be violated the most during acts of war and there should be constraints on states on intervening for humanitarian reasons because it might splash into a more disastrous outcome (Linklater, 2005b; Bellamy, 2005). This view conflicts with Dunne and Wheeler, who emphasize a Solidarist view claiming the need for humanitarian interventions underscoring the need for states to adopt such moral obligations to ensure the safety and the preservation of justice. This tension between views underscores the dichotomy between the English school scholars and the lack of clear analysis of how the international system works, I believe it's a weakness that the scholars have not blurred the lines on this dichotomy and the lack of consensus between them (Linklater, 2005b; Bellamy, 2005).

Another problem is that it ought to become concerned with how raw force as well as absence of careful communication between nations might reverse the minimal achievement that has been made (such as human rights abuse not being sidelined issue). For instance, apartheid (system of segregation) now is frowned upon system that is universally accepted, in which in the past was seen as a norm but now is dissolved. In contrast, the English school's strength is its ability to clarify the intricate relationship between justice and order, as well as its hope that states will

eventually achieve a balance between the two and its support for gradual alterations rather than unrealistic ideals.

Moving on to the second part of the question on “Revolt against the West”. The revolt is about former colonies, especially non-Western governments, who are against westernized standards in the worldwide society of states. According to the English school, there are several distinct parts to a revolt towards the West. The initial phase was the effort for equality in sovereignty, which was pushed primarily by communities featuring both China and Japan, who preserved their official autonomy but were seen as being subordinate to the countries of the West. The political revolt towards the West, particularly occurred during the subsequent stage, witnessed the previous territories who had surrendered their liberty demanding a halt to colonial authority. The fight to eradicate enslavement, the slave trade, and every other manifestation of white supremacist subjugation to achieve liberty and equality is reflected in the third stage, that is the racial revolution towards the west. The revolt opposing oppression along with disparities in wealth constituted the fourth stage. The final movement is a cultural revolt opposing westernized imperialistic cultural principles as well as the belief that the West may implement its norms and dictate the way other people ought to function (Linklater, 2005b; Bellamy, 2005).

It was argued that the initial four features of the developing world called to occidental ideas of liberty and justice and sought to convince the colonizers that they should consider the values they hold substantially throughout their interactions regarding the non-western nations. Nevertheless, the cultural revolt was distinct in that it was typically a revolution against occidental principles (Linklater, 2005b; Bellamy, 2005). International society did grow as a result of this uprising against the West, nonetheless it additionally whipped up entirely novel forms of disagreements and division. The consequence for current international relations is evidenced by the religious revolution against Westernized ideals. Example is al Qaeda and the 9/11 attacks. Another modern

illustration of how the revolution against the West continues to impact the international system is the BRICS economic model, which opposes the Western economic model and alters the fragile equilibrium of order and justice. The fact that till now contestations around human rights and which human rights matter and whether intervening is permissible or not, and the development and the widening of the gap between west and south regarding economy underscores the various outlooks regarding setting up universal norms and values. This circles back to the previous argument that reaching universal consensus and finding a balance between Order and Justice and the international society progressing into exhibiting a Solidarist stance rather than a pluralist one seems improbable (Linklater, 2005b; Bellamy, 2005). In conclusion, The English School of thoughts strength in addressing such issues lies within the fact that it offers a nuanced perspective especially when its ideas and arguments centers in the middle of realist school of thought and idealism taking into consideration not only the struggle for power but also offering normative insights on what should be. The second strength is its ability to explain how the universal order differentiated within various historical events, such an ability provided a great insight on the interaction between countries. Its weakness lies within the fact, as mentioned earlier, a clear reasoning to which in fact is much more important to give importance to (Justice or order), there is a lack of consensus upon that. Another weakness is that the reader might sense a Western-centric ideals within the text, even though the English school have addressed different outlooks that are non-western.

Section 3: - Simulation Exercise

3.2: - The Russia-Ukraine Conflict: Analyze the ongoing conflict between Russia and Ukraine, including the involvement of NATO and other external actors.

The ongoing conflict between Russia and Ukraine did not start in February 2022, however it goes back to Russia's annexation of the Crimean Peninsula. The takeover of the Crimean Peninsula from

Ukraine in early 2014, as well as the full-scale invasion of Ukraine's lands in 2022, were the most momentous moves made by Russian President Vladimir Putin since assuming power. Waltz structural realism with defensive realism is the international relations theory that is being used to examine the current issue between Russia and Ukraine. The best theory for interpreting and analyzing the Russia's motives, actions, and results of its war on East Ukraine and the acquisition of territory is defensive realism, which holds that Russia is attempting to safeguard the Security of the nation and preserve its interests, while also ensuring the safety of the Russian-speaking society there (Waltz, 1979; Treisman, 2016; United Nations, 2024).

The influence of other parties, particularly the North Atlantic Treaty Organization, will be addressed. Further, I will examine the prospective constraints of using Defensive Realism while considering how alternative theoretical framework may interpret this situation differently. First, I shall provide thorough information on Defensive Realism. According to Waltz structural realism, state-to-state rivalry is a battle for domination rather than a reflection of humanity's inherent traits. The author believes that universal structures shape how states perform throughout the global setting. The international system lacks universal authority or a global government that checks and balances, making it impossible to hold states responsible for their own activities. As a result, anarchy is the driving force behind certain state activities. Waltz's structural defensive realism differs from Morgenthau's Offensive Realist concept, as it focuses on the actions of nations throughout the international structure. Defensive realists contend that states are primarily concerned with preserving the status quo than with altering it. Rather than increasing authority, they emphasize security and stability of the nation. It is imperative for States to maintain the current state of affairs in order to avoid counterbalancing alliances and trigger regional insecurity (Waltz, 1979). It must be said that Russia's annexation of the Crimean Peninsula and the invasion

of East Ukraine was fueled by Russia's desire to protect its own interests in terms of economy or territorial acquisitions, and tranquility throughout the region. (Waltz, 1979; Treisman, 2016; United Nations, 2024). According to a defensive Realist, the Kremlin's motives are solely defensive in nature, aimed at preventing the North Atlantic Treaty from progressing toward the east. Russia views the North Atlantic Treaty Organization's encroachment approaching its territorial boundaries represents an imminent risk to Russian sovereignty as well as national security. It considers the North Atlantic Treaty Mission to incorporate all post-Soviet states into the alliance as a strategic tool to contain Russia.

It is also clear that the Russian acquisition of Crimea was a proactive step toward establishing its strategic breadth (Waltz, 1979; Treisman, 2016; The Conversation, 2022). Ukraine is driven mostly by the desire to protect itself from Russian potential assault, and it considers that joining western powers—such as the European Union and the North Atlantic Treaty Organization—is the only viable solution. However, from the standpoint of defensive realism, Ukraine's strategy incited hostilities up the region and made Moscow feel unsettled through such motivating actions, forcing Russia to take defensive action to defend its own sovereignty and geopolitical objectives. External forces like NATO and Western nations have been involved in the conflict between Ukraine and Russia by providing Ukraine with military equipment, personnel, and drones to stop Russian attacks. According to a defensive perspective, meanwhile, this just serves to increase hostilities and validate Russian concerns about being enveloped by Western forces. Russia fears an enclosure by NATO since all its interests lie in the Sevastopol Black fleet and if that be taken away from it which it would lose all its power in the Mediterranean region (Waltz, 1979; Treisman, 2016; Statista, 2023; Reuters, 2024). The potential outcome of the Ukraine-Russia war is still unclear and ambiguous but from a defensive realist stance we could say that either a stalemate or further tensions will prevail as drone attacks are still being conducted by Russians on the Ukrainian

Territories. It seems like it is more than the aim for Russia to imperialize but rather to make sure its security is never on edge (Reuters, 2024).

Kenneth Waltz contends that States aim to preserve, not control, their place in anarchic systems (Waltz, 1979). This statement argues in favor of using defensive realism as a useful theoretical framework for examining Moscow's actions. Russia is more concerned with preserving its standing in the region free from Western influence or intrusion, which could undermine its integrity and authority, than it is with gaining more power (Waltz, 1979). However, there might be considerable weakness in using Defensive Realism as a tool in analyzing the Ukraine-Russian ongoing crisis. Defensive realism turns a blind eye on the identity role within the domestic levels such as the strong Russian nationalistic feeling that might have triggered this war or ignores the fact that it might have been Putin's errors in judgment which have been reported a lot that he is an impulsive leader (Stoessinger, 2010; Treisman, 2016). Defensive realism also turns a blind eye on the normative aspect of the conflict. It doesn't display that Russians' actions were a violation of the territorial integrity of Ukraine but rather justifies it. Well, it's imperative to understand that Realism is an Amoral theory (Donnelly, 2005).

Constructivism, in my opinion, is an alternate theory that could provide a more thorough analysis of the war between Russia and Ukraine. Constructivism is keen on how common values, norms, identities structure the interactions between states rather than material elements such as the economy or the accumulation of power, resources and so on. The war on Ukraine by Moscow could be due to identities and how Russia perceives itself and Ukraine. It's imperative to note that Ukraine and Russia share a lot of history especially when it comes to the Crimean Peninsula which has always been disputed on. It is possible that Moscow views Kiev to be within its broader cultural and geopolitical domain, which drove it to invade Ukraine and stop it from falling under the western influence. So, Ukraine's resistance to Russia's objective of not making Ukraine fall under

the westernized agenda and ideology sparked even more tensions in the region and triggered an all-out war. So, constructivism could be a great analytical tool explaining how shared meanings, historical stories, identity, norms and values all dictated Russia's behavior (Rues-Smit, 2005; National Geographic, 2023).

If I were an advisor and I were to offer a course of action for Russia in its conflict with Ukraine, I think I would encourage it to halt the conflict through diplomatic measures. A ceasefire agreement should be the first step, and then Russia ought to sit down with the main party, Ukraine, and NATO representatives to consider a settlement that would assure Ukraine's autonomy in exchange for NATO's withdrawal from around Russia's border or if that didn't work at least to end the expansion of it. It might seem highly unlikely that the war could end now without such compromises. But something must be given to Russia in return for it to end the conflict and withdraw from the Ukrainian lands.

Section 4: - Synthesis and Reflection

4.1:- Reflect on the challenges and opportunities for building a more inclusive and just international order. Consider diverse worldviews, material and ideational factors, and the role of different actors (states, non-state actors, individuals). ****Specifically, discuss which theoretical perspective you have found most useful for thinking about these issues, and why.****

Building a more inclusive and just international order, in my opinion, seems like an impractical goal, but it is crucial to remain optimistic and look for different approaches to problems in order to establish universal ground for conducting certain operations that call for resolving conflicting viewpoints around the world, addressing historical injustices, and combining material and ideational forces because material forces by themselves are insufficient. There are fundamental challenges that one can come across when trying to assess world and international relations. Power is not distributed equally amongst states all around the world, this inequality favors one nation

over multiple others. We can see this disparity within multiple organizations, claiming to be neutral, like the United Nations. The United Nations claims to be neutral, however five permanent members dictate how interactions flow, and what resolutions to pass (veto power) hindering the prospect of a just international order. We can see this in the Israeli Palestinian conflict and how crimes against humanity have been conducted on innocent Palestinian civilians, and the United Nations stood there in silence. It was seen coming since one of the founding members of the UN, the United States, which holds a veto power and is funding Israel's war on Gaza. There is a contradiction on the principles put there in theory and the practice of such organizations. This also underscores another challenge, which is the cultural divisions regarding values universally. This issue hinders any prospects for universal consensus regarding the rights of individuals, what constitutes sovereignty and so on. Within the same example regarding Palestinian Israeli conflict the international community is divided into multiple fronts but mainly two, the ones who accept what's going on and the other front is totally against. This just portrays how universal justice renders difficult to achieve since each side of the world views justice in a different way. However, there is some optimism to challenge the reality of power being consolidated in one part of the region into the whole world. The rise of powers such as India, Pakistan, China to counter American hegemony is of great optimism because at least a different model would emerge, and domination by one entity in all aspects of life can be reduced. Example, BRICS challenging the western economic model. This highlights inclusivity. Western powers have long exercised exploitation on the south and their influence (negative) is lingering on different parts of the world, imposing their values thinking it is the best form but doesn't acknowledge the cultural differences and the differences in values. Human rights have also been taken into consideration in some respects although it's not effective in most institutions but there are some states who are abiding by international law and some of the international courts they're signatory of. Although my views

tend to be pessimistic but i believe constructivism is the best approach in providing a nuanced thinking on how the world works away from the realist's analysis that just explain how the world is without giving room for improvement and away from the liberal ideals which is dominated by western values. Constructivism is inclusive as a political theory and promotes justice by emphasizing the power identities, norms, and values in constructing the behavior of states not only material forces. Furthermore, Constructivism puts immense importance on humans, individuals and groups as agents in structuring and forging universal values. Circling back to the Palestinian Israeli conflict. The Palestinian and Arab civil society all around the globe from the United States to Canada and all over Europe made various demonstrations and strikes on the streets, advocating or the rights of the Palestinians through media outlets, showing a narrative that has been long silenced by the west. Civil society campaigns to boycott Israeli-made or pro-Israel products have also given a fresh meaning and put demands on governments to review their policies. The narrative and norms surrounding occupation and resistance have changed as a result of these activities.

4.2:- Reflect on how your understanding of international relations theory has evolved over the course of this class and identify at least one area in which you would like to do further research.*

My understanding of international relations before the class and after it has changed drastically.

It shifted from portraying or viewing the world from a realist perspective into acknowledging that in cooperating diverse views such as constructivism, critical theory, English school and postmodernism. The class provided me with a nuanced outlook on the world. Each of these theories adds into your thinking and expands our perspective on how things operate. I believe labeling oneself into a certain ideology is reductionist and insufficient, especially if you are an International Relations student like me. I believe International Relations students should not fall into the trap of confining oneself to any theory because it triggers a counter effect and does not

challenge them to think. I used to hold strong opinions regarding realism especially on the state's power and its interactions with other states are reflected in its military capabilities and economic resources. But then I realized that material forces are as significant as how identities, shared norms and values are in constructing and shifting states conduct. Moreover, I'm very keen on exploring and doing more research on the post-colonial theory, especially on the way colonialism still holds a significant amount of influence on the post-colonized nations. I believe that post-colonial theory is pretty much not explored and there is an immense need to explore and study the dynamic of postcolonialism and its adverse effects especially on women, the economy and the failed governance there.

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